



FINAL EXPENSE Life Insurance
SALES PRESENTATION ©

Customer Objection/Concern, Agent Rebuttal Script

www.finalexpensesuccess.com ©

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Other publications by Dr. Troy G. Clark at www.troyclark.net

The secret to selling is to *sell the secret*. ©

(Explaining your product should sound like the
“best kept secret”
in the entire insurance industry.
Make qualifying for one of your plans a
“mystery of anticipation”.)

Troy G. Clark, Ph.D.

Life ♦ Insurance

1809, Noun

Providing payment of a stipulated sum
to a designated beneficiary
upon death of the insured.

Merriam-Webster's Dictionary
11th Collegiate Version 3.0, 2003

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Customer Objections Explained

Any customer objection to making a buying decision today can be slight apprehension over a minor unaddressed detail, or a polite way of saying “not right now”. Rarely does any customer ever bluntly say “No, I do not want your coverage”. Simply put, a customer *objection* is not always a *rejection*. It is simply the customer’s way of telling me *how to make the sale*.

I look at a customer objection at the close of a sales presentation as a final plea for help with a certain obstacle in the customer’s way to purchase coverage today. It is the final “tie down”. A customer is giving me their objection, because they want me to know that they need more help to overcome something specific without actually saying so.

An expert telesales agent has ***already curbed*** several *potential* objections previously within prior pages of our Sales Presentation Script at www.finalexperiencesuccess.com. In addition, both agent and customer would not even arrive at the close of a sale, unless a customer has previously indicated: 1) they have a legitimate need for whole life insurance coverage today, 2) they have a means to pay with a valid bank account, 3) they are the “Financial Decision Maker”.

Because an expert agent talks to literally scores of people every day who have previously inquired into end-of-life benefits, a customer does not realize that the longer they put off the opportunity for immediate coverage, the greater they are at risk of **losing opportunity for coverage** due to changes in their health, unpredictable changes in coverage premiums, and an agent’s loss to forget a procrastinating customer. It behooves an expert agent to give the customer a gentle “nudge” to decide today if this coverage is right for them.

If a senior customer has inadequate or no coverage at all for funeral and burial expenses, and can also afford the monthly premiums, an agent would ultimately be doing a disservice to the customer’s family to not try to close the sale immediately. I simply do not play games with a customer at the close. It’s either yes or no. Is this coverage right for you, or not?

An agent’s fleeting time is “money”, for a commission-based agent. So, I expect nothing less than a straight answer from a customer. There is typically a customer question, concern, or objection at the close of my sales delivery. However, I have no time for “cat-n-mouse games”. I accept the challenge of objections head-on for what the customer says. However, I want to get to the root of any customer objection to help the customer overcome virtually EVERY obstacle in their path to close the sale TODAY. Or, is the customer simply saying “no” to my coverage plan altogether. I need to know which it is.

Is this a real sale, or not?

FINAL EXPENSE SELLING POINTERS

**Because this “selling” script is to be adapted to field or phone sales for salesmen/women, please consider the following additional pointers to owning a superior scripted Selling Script:*

- A customer’s reaction to an agent typically equals the agent’s own selling disposition. That is, what an agent transfers over the phone, or in person, to a customer, is mostly how a customer treats an agent. If an agent exudes an unenthusiastic, low voice volume, or frustrated disposition, the customer will react to the agent with a low interest level of enthusiasm, or negative disinterest. If an agent treats his/her customer to enthusiastic, professional, upbeat, positivity, and authoritative cheer, the customer will more likely “perk up”, pay attention, and listen with interest.
- RECORD YOURSELF answering customer objections to a “pretend customer”. Listen to your recording. Would you buy a policy from YOU? If not, why should your customer? Always improve **how you sound** while answering customer objections!
- This Sales Script works best if your prospect customer previously responded to some type of lead inquiry (Ex: Mailer, Telemarketer, TV, etc.) giving the customer an opportunity to respond and request more information on final expense coverage.
- Because many people need professional assistance to overcome procrastination, seniors without any, or little, life insurance coverage put their family at risk of a burden of approx. \$7,000-\$12,000 immediate funeral bill, if they should pass away at any moment.
- Many people living on savings, Social Security, or Disability, are unable to afford large, expensive-type life insurance plans. Helping these folks to make a right decision that would fit into their individual lifestyle, and budget, is important. A large funeral bill, outstanding credit card debt, nursing care bills, etc., puts financial stress on a surviving spouse or children of the deceased. Final Expense Insurance is a wonderful way to individually eliminate this burden on an entire family.
- In this Sales Script Manual, the term “Licensed Field Underwriter” should only be applied to an agent who has previously secured permission from an insurance carrier to do so, while selling their product. Otherwise, replace the term “Licensed Field Underwriter” with “Final Expense Representative”.

Selling Techniques To Avoid

1. **Twisting** involves convincing a client to replace an existing policy, or switch insurance companies, through misrepresenting the existing policy's terms and values. Never tell a prospective client that your policy benefits will do something, knowing that it will not do it. Never tell a prospective client that their existing policy will not do something without reviewing their actual policy first.
2. A **Rebate** is illegal for both the agent and the consumer. An inducement offered (anything of value) not specified in the agent's policy contract within an insurance purchase agreement is a rebate. It is illegal for any person to offer or accept such an inducement.
3. An agent may not charge in excess of the policy premium for the performance of the agent's service.
4. It is also a misdemeanor to the agent in most states to transact a contract that is unlawfully executed. That is, soliciting and transacting business with a non-licensed company.
5. Knowingly making false statements on an application is punishable in most states as a Class I felony. This includes insurance agents, physicians in charge of medical checks, or applicants of life insurance. A blank application cannot be signed legally by an agent. Exceptions may be travel accident insurance, or a baggage loss policy, intended for issuance through a coin-operated machine.
6. Refrain from "hustling" or "badgering" a customer with untrue or unkind remarks, i.e.: "This is your last chance to ever qualify for these benefits", "Don't be a fool, sign up today", "If you wait another day to apply for this coverage, your chance will be lost forever."
7. Inherent within the insurance industry, unfortunately, are licensed agents whose only concern is to position a potential client to "sign on the dotted line" at all cost. To do so, a dishonest agent may withhold important, deal breaking information from the customer about a certain policy feature that may influence the customer's decision one way or another. For example, if a plan for coverage has a 2-3 year "waiting period" before 100% of the natural death benefits goes into full force, the customer should know this up front during the initial explanation of the benefits. If the "waiting period" is not properly and thoroughly explained at the time of purchase by the sales agent, a family may get surprised by the sting of having a fraction or zero coverage they were counting on, if the client passes away during the 2-3 year "waiting/elimination period". Up front honesty by the agent always wins more success in the long run.
8. Misrepresenting your product, or the product of another company that a customer is currently insured with, is detrimental to both parties involved and is no way to begin a lifelong, trusting business relationship. A customer is more likely to buy from a forthright, honest agent, who holds nothing back from the customer. There must be no "surprises" later to the customer or agent. On the flip side of this coin is manipulating a customer to buy insurance based upon untrue or over-the-top explanations of policy benefits. An agent must never promise a customer that their policy will do something that it will not do. We officially term this "twisting" of the facts in insurance terminology. If a professional agent is unsure how to explain policy benefits, or how to answer a customer's question about benefits, a correct response would be:

"That's a good question. Let me make sure I can give you an accurate answer by looking it up for you. Because I am a professional, I do not want either of us to be surprised later by giving you a guess answer. We'll come back to that later, I promise."

An Insurance Commissioner may revoke, suspend, or deny licensure to any individual for:

- ☹ Cheating on the State Licensing Exam.
- ☹ Fraud.
- ☹ Misrepresentation of policy terms.
- ☹ Violation of any insurance law.
- ☹ Misappropriation of funds.
- ☹ Conviction involving moral turpitude or any felony.
- ☹ Violation of the Unfair Trade Practice.
- ☹ Coercive or dishonest practices.
- ☹ Forging names on an application.
- ☹ Failure to comply with continuing education requirements.

Customer Objections/Concerns, Agent Rebuttals

**The objection/rebuttals below represent the most common an agent faces approx. 99% of the time.*

1. Customer Objection: ***“Send Me Something In The Mail.”***

Agent Rebuttal: Sure! Which plan here at my department do you qualify for? I have several plans available that are state approved, but they are specific to your age and health. Since I do not know you, YOU TELL ME what is the name of our plan here that I can send you information on...Which one do you qualify for? *(Wait for customer response, “I don’t know.”)* Well, I don’t either. There are a few health questions to go over with you, in order for me to assess the level of benefits you are entitled to. Do have a moment...?

Agent Rebuttal: I understand. It is important to see what we’re talking about. We send those who qualify a complete packet in the mail on every benefit that is available to you for the plan you qualify for. The plans are age and health specific. What is your age...Do you have a few moments to follow our state guidelines to answer a few health questions, so that I can identify the level of benefits you are entitled to?

Agent Rebuttal: It’s nice of you to try to make my job easier. Unfortunately, if I spent all day mailing information, I wouldn’t get my job done. I have a “long line of families standing behind you” reaching out for my help today. To save us both some time, why don’t I briefly explain who I am and what I do to help folks just like you every day. That will let us both know the level of benefits you are entitled to. After I clear up your questions, you tell me what to do next, ok?

Agent Rebuttal: Absolutely. If you qualify for our state regulated benefits, my secretary will send you a Welcome Packet today in the mail with all of my contact information, all the information about the program you select, and our Free Gift, called our Memorial Guide. We offers several coverage plans that are age and health specific. As a licensed field underwriter, I do not require any medical exam, so I simply ask a few, basic health questions to determine the level of benefits you are entitled to. What is your date of birth...?

2. Customer Objection: ***“I don’t remember making any inquiry into your benefits.”***

Agent Rebuttal: I’m sorry. It’s probably my fault for getting back late to you. I see that your inquiry was made --- days/weeks ago. The demand for our benefits is high here. In fact, I have several appointments today, but I did not want you to fall through the cracks here. I apologize, if I am getting back late with you, ok? Is your full name ---? Is your correct address ----? Ok, looks like I have right person here.

Agent Rebuttal: Sure. If you’re like me, I can’t remember what I did a couple days ago. I have a stack of 50 contacts sitting on my desk every morning for people that make inquiries here at our department, and I never seem to make it through all 50. It could

have been a while back, but the important thing is that we are together now. We realize every contact is important, and I'll do everything I can to help you receive the level of benefits you are entitled to. Let's see what you qualify for, ok?

Agent Rebuttal: What do you want me to do with your personal information that was given to us? *(Pause for customer response, "What personal information?")* Is your correct address...? Is your full name...? Is your date of birth...? Is your correct phone number...? Someone, who knows your personal information made a request for you. I wonder who that could be...? It arrived on my desk today for a free quote ASAP on state approved cash benefits available now in (Customer City) for funeral and burial protection. I'll help you and your family every way that I can, while you have me on the phone. Now is the best time for me. How about you?

3. Customer Objection: *"I already have some insurance."*

Agent Rebuttal: Super! I wish everybody could say that. Most people wait, until it's too late. I commend you for planning ahead. You're smart. What is the purpose of your current life insurance? Is it for the survivor to live on, if one of you pass away? Ok. Most people that I assist already have some type of insurance in place. However, most are not comfortable, until they have a small, affordable, permanent plan just for funeral and burial expense. Here's why: If your survivor has to watch \$10,000-\$15,000 of your current coverage "go into the ground" to pay for your funeral and final expenses, it erases your plan for the survivor to have plenty to live on. Our cash benefits pay out quickly, within the first week – this is money that can go "into the ground" – so that your current coverage remains untouched by death.

Agent Rebuttal: Excellent. I wish everybody could say that. Most people wait, until it's too late. I commend you for planning ahead. You're smart. What you may not be aware of is that when a spouse passes away, that means typically a 50% loss of income. The survivor may not be able to carry on if the life insurance you have now is used up paying off a funeral, or a mortgage. Our cash benefits create an "instant estate". They protect your assets, and provide instant income for the survivor.

4. Customer Objection: *"I do not share my bank account information" / "I only pay with a check or money order."*

Agent Rebuttal: It is in the best interest of each customer set up your payments on a bank service plan for serious reasons. Suppose you go into a hospital, or worse, a nursing care facility. Your policy will NOT lapse if your bank is sending in your premium payments each month. We've learned the hard way, if we allow customers to send in premium payments through the mail, a hospital or nursing home stay ends your ability to mail payments, causing a lapse, or DOUBLE payments, or even worse, CANCELLATION of your coverage. Some people have lost coverage that they have been paying on for 20-30 years! A bank service plan helps you to avoid this threat. We expect you to live well into your 90's! It is in light of these realities that we only allow your bank to send in your premium payments.

Agent Rebuttal: 2 Advantages to Monthly Bank Draft:

1. One of the first things a family will do when someone passes away is, they will go to your bank to close out your account. At that point, the bank manager will bring out your bank statement. This is where your family will look at it and REALIZE that no one has to dig into their own pockets to pay for your funeral. The bank will always have a record of your payments to the insurance company. We expect you to live another 20-30 years into your 90's! By that time, you may forget you even have this coverage plan well in your 90's, but the bank will ALWAYS have a record of it.
2. If you go into the hospital or a nursing care facility in the distance future, your bank will continue to keep your death benefits in place with premium payments remaining current. This is normally a FREE service with any bank for consumer safety reasons. You will always have a record of your exact payment in your monthly bank statement recorded in black-n-white, so you know exactly what's happening.

Agent Rebuttal: Is your check direct deposited each month into your bank account? Do you know why Social Security / Disability does it this way now? Because, checks get lost or stolen through the mail. Your plan is set up for security reasons on a bank service plan to prevent this from happening. Just like Social Security, the insurance companies have trouble with payments getting stolen or lost in the mail as well. You never want your policy to lapse or terminate, because a payment did not make it to the insurance company. You could potentially lose protection coverage that you have paying on for years, if you ever go into a hospital or nursing care facility. Does that make sense to you?

Agent Rebuttal: Suppose you pulled your vehicle into a convenience store gas station to fill up with gas. On the gas pump you notice a make-shift sign that reads "No Personal Checks / Money Orders". Would you be the type of person that would fill up your vehicle with gas, knowing what the sign says, then walk inside to pay and insist on using a personal check, because you don't care what the sign at the pump reads? Our sign here reads "No Personal Checks". We prefer to allow your bank to send in the payments for consumer safety reasons. We simply do not allow personal checks through the mail, for your protection.

Besides, premium payments are higher when paid through the mail, if we allowed it, because of administrative costs. Let's move forward. Let's get the lowest premiums. Let's put this last piece of the puzzle together, then you are set for life with coverage.

Agent Rebuttal: Have you ever written a check to the pizza delivery guy? Grocery store? As you know, this never authorizes them to draw money from your bank account. YOU are the only person who can give that authorization to your bank. This is what you are doing today with your policy application. You are authorizing your bank to send in monthly payments to the insurance company. The only information required is the information that you would normally give to the pizza delivery guy / grocery store. Once we set it up through your local bank, you're set for life!

5. Customer Objection: *"I need more time to think about it". "Can I call you back?"*

Agent Rebuttal: Sure. Take all the time you need. As I am working at my desk here for 5-10 minutes, decide which plan works best for you. Take all the time you need to discuss it among yourselves. When you decide, just pick the phone back up, and let me know which plan is right for your budget, while I have approval for your plan today.

Agent Rebuttal:

1. No Mam/Sir. I prefer that we apply for the benefits, while you've got me on the phone with you.
2. No Mam/Sir. I prefer that we decide which one is right for you, while you've got me on the phone with you.
3. No Mam/Sir. My schedule is extremely busy today. You have a long line of families "standing behind you" reaching out for my help. The demand for our benefits is high right now. My day tomorrow is even busier, and the rest of the week/month is worse in my schedule. You don't have to spend any money today. I have the authority to begin your plan on the day of the month that is comfortable for you, at the price you can afford. Which one of the 3 plans appeal to you the most?

Agent Rebuttal: Sure. You could wait another (Ex: 62) years. Makes no difference to me. But, God forbid, if something should happen tonight to you, do you want your family's last memory of you on this Earth to be that you gave your family thousands of dollars of debt? Every adult starts thinking about death at midlife. You've been thinking about it now for more than 20 years. How much more time do you need to think about it? Let's get it settled today. Let me help you, so you can leave behind a right example legacy to your family that will show them how to take care of their own final expenses. Sound good?

Agent Rebuttal: I am not allowed to "hold the benefits" open for anyone. The lowest premium rates can go up for people who wait. If you are serious about permanently protecting your family's future, I don't need any money today, so let's help you get the benefits you want, while I have approval. I can lock these benefits into place permanently, so that your plan never changes after today. I speak to two types of people. Those who say later, *"I wish I had"*, and those who say *"I'm glad I did"*. Which person sounds smart to you?

Agent Rebuttal: Suppose I have a big "Crystal Ball" in front of us here. We could look into the "Crystal Ball" and be able to predict the day of our death. We would then get life insurance one month before death, so that we are paying the least amount of cost and getting the most amount of benefit. Since there is no such "Crystal Ball", this is why we purchase life insurance. No one knows when death will occur. You can wait as long as you want to, but people who wait, wait too late. One trip to the doctor, or one trip down a flight of stairs, can eliminate your chances forever to qualify for life insurance. Does it sound smart to you to wait without knowing when death will occur and without being able to predict the future?

Agent Rebuttal: This is not important tomorrow. This is important today. The more you get into the habit of “putting off”, the more opportunity you’ll lose to take care of your future. If you go to the doctor tomorrow, and he, for example, puts you on insulin for diabetes, the premiums you are looking at today could skyrocket up to \$10-\$40 more for the same coverage. The premiums will never be any cheaper than they are today. I realize peace of mind about death benefits is a scary step for you. So, let’s take the first step forward together. Which plan works best for you?

Agent Rebuttal: In providing a solution to your worries that you had when you made the inquiry here, here’s the real question. Maybe this will help you as it helped me, and my grandfather taught me this by the way. I ask myself the “Golden Question”. Here it is: In my heart and soul, do I think this is the right thing to do? And that’s the most important thing. If it passes that test, the clincher is always HAVE I EVER ONCE IN MY LIFE BEEN SORRY FOR DOING THE RIGHT THING? Does that make sense to you? Now, (Customer Name), in YOUR heart and soul, do you think this is the right thing to do? And have you ever ONCE been sorry for doing the RIGHT thing?

6. Customer Objection: “*I need to talk it over with___*”.

Agent Rebuttal: Do you like apple pie? If I were to prepare, then give to you a hot, steaming, freshly baked apple pie, with a half gallon of vanilla ice cream to go with it, would you then eat the whole pie? (*Pause for customer response – “No”*) Of course not. You can take a slice of pie that is comfortable now, and always come back later for another slice. Same principle here. You take a slice of coverage that is comfortable for you now, and if your family ever wants you to get more later, you simply get another slice of the “coverage pie” by calling my desk direct. Funeral costs go up about 5% each year, so you may want to look at this again in another 3-5 years.

Agent Rebuttal: It is great that you have (children, friend, family) to bounce things off of. A lot of people do not have a support system of family/friends. Most of the time, when a senior shares their plan to get life insurance with adult children, the son/daughter most often say, “*We’ll take care of it, mom/dad. Don’t worry about it.*” The reason why they say this, is because they don’t want to think about YOU dying. However, we need to realize it is not their responsibility. It is an individual duty to remove the burden of your final expenses away from your family. Do you want your funeral expenses (\$7-12,000) to potentially take finances away from your grandchildren, because their parents had to pay your final bills? You are the Matriarch/Patriarch of your entire family! You are leaving behind a legacy, the right example, for the rest of your family to follow. Let’s move forward to put your benefits in place permanently, so that your family will learn from your passing, how to take of their own responsibility of final expenses. Once your plan is in place, if your family wants you to get more coverage later, simply call my desk direct.

7. Customer Objection: *"This doesn't seem like enough coverage for the premium."*

Agent Rebuttal: I understand. You are (Ex: 64) years young now. How many years ago did you take out your (Ex: \$4,000) coverage that you already have in place? The reason why I am asking will give you a clearer picture of your insurance options at this point in your life. There are two things in insurance that determine coverage amounts and premiums. Do you know what they are? It is your 1)age, and your 2)health. Now, I don't about where you are, but where I come from, people do not get any younger. Would you agree? And, the more we age, do we get healthier or more unhealthy? Even though you have a (Ex: Heart condition), I am still willing to qualify you at my department, whereas a lot of insurance companies would not even want to talk to you. Now, if you went to the doctor tomorrow, and he put you on insulin, your premiums for this same coverage could be (Ex: \$10-\$40) higher for the same coverage. These premiums will never get any cheaper than they are right now! You have the Top Plan in front of you that you qualify for with me. I will be your personal contact representative for life. You can always pick up the phone and talk to me direct, if your family ever wants you to get more coverage later. Which one of the 3 options will take care of your family, if something were to happen to you tonight?

Agent Rebuttal: Look at your benefits as a bucket of money. Your coverage (Ex: \$10,000) is a \$10,000 bucket of money that (Insurance Company) sets aside with your name on it. When you make ONE, small premium payment, the bucket of money becomes yours for one month. Your funeral is PAID for, if you pass away in the first month, with only one payment. You keep paying the premiums, your \$10,000 bucket of money stays the same. The \$10,000 bucket of money pays out to (Customer Beneficiary) immediately within 48 hours-5 business days after your decease. One payment. One Big Bucket of Money!

8. Customer Objection: *"My premiums over time will exceed my total coverage."*

Agent Rebuttal: You do not have to pay in more premiums than the total amount of your policy coverage, if you do not want to. Here's 2 Reasons why:

1) The Mortality Rate. The female life expectancy average is 78 years(*male – 72 years*). You are (Ex: 72) now. In 6 years at age 78, you will need to outlive 99% of all females your age to pay 4 more years of premiums up to age 82, to equal your \$6,000 coverage. And, we hope that you do! Point is, these premium payments are based on the Mortality Rate Chart, so that people do not lose money, nor outlive your policy.

2) Let's suppose you outlive the female expectancy of 78 years and live to be 100. Typically, the insurance company notifies a customer when a plan "matures" at age 100. Before you turn 100, you generally have 2 options: a) be paid your cash value that has accumulated inside of your policy, which oftentimes equals or comes close to your total coverage amount. Or, b) you may be able to keep your coverage as a paid-up policy with (Insurance Company). You are "rewarded" for being a survivor and would not lose your coverage, or premiums that you paid in.

9. Customer Objection: *"I can put these premium amounts into my bank each month, and save up for my funeral bill."*

Agent Rebuttal: I appreciate your foresight. However, you are missing the most important point to all of this. Do you have a personal banker, there at (Customer Bank)? What is his/her name? Maybe a banker who secured your mortgage or car loan. "Marty"? Ok. What if you set an appointment to see "Marty" at (Customer Bank), there in (Customer City). At your appointment you told "Marty" that you are going to put in \$50 every month to a savings account, or CD, at (Customer Bank). In return for your \$50 deposit per month into Marty's bank, you want the bank to give your family the sum of \$10,000 immediately when you die. Even if you pass away next month, you want Marty and (Customer Bank) to give your family \$10,000 cash immediately, because of your \$50 monthly deposit. Would they do it? Of course not. (Customer Name), you are getting (Ex: \$10,000) permanent protection for only \$50 per month here. When you make ONLY one premium payment, your funeral is paid for. Even if you pass away next month, your funeral is paid for. Does it sound smart to take care of your final expenses at a bank, or at (Insurance Company). Now, which one of these 3 options appeals the most to you? Which one would take care of your family, if something were to happen to you tonight?

10. Customer Objection: *"I do not share my Social Security number."*

Agent Rebuttal: I understand. Tell me more about that...Did you purchase your car? Did you have to fill out an application for that? Did you purchase your home? Did you have to fill out a loan application for that home to be purchased? Ok. This is virtually the same paperwork process – only I AM DOING IT FOR YOU. This application is your contract with (Insurance Company), so that the benefits legally go to the correct person by your Social Security number. We need to be able to verify that you are who you are. Since you have filled out applications before, you realize that any legally accurate document requires a Social Security number, correct?

Agent Rebuttal: Your Social Security number makes this a legal transaction. This program is state regulated. Do you want to follow the legal guidelines? You tell me what to do.

Agent Rebuttal: Your benefits can not be processed without verifying your identify. This is the most important bit of information on your application. (Customer Beneficiary) would not receive the cash benefits without it. This must be a legally accurate document for (Customer Beneficiary) to be paid the benefits 100%. This is confidential information for your application to be submitted to the insurance carrier for proper processing. I trust you to provide correct information. What is your social?

11. Customer Objection: *"I can't afford it."*

Agent Rebuttal: I know what you mean. It's expensive to live. It's also expensive to die. When death occurs, sacrifices must be made. Two sacrifices come to mind. Emotional and Financial. Only time and God can take care of losing a loved one

emotionally. What we are planning for together today is taking care of your family's financial stress. Is it easier to pay a little bit at a time for your funeral now, or your family to have to come up with thousands all at once? I know I don't have \$10,000 just lying around in my sock drawer! Decide that your loved ones are worth it to put your plan in place today. You'll never have to worry about this again. It is a permanent solution to an unpredictable, unavoidable event. Does that sound like a winner?

Agent Rebuttal: Are you watching TV right now? Do you have cable TV? Is having cable TV more important to you right now, than your family's indebtedness, when you pass away? For the cost of one family restaurant meal per month, you can take care of your final funeral bill today. It is not easy on any of us to fulfill our responsibilities, but it is necessary. Let's do the right thing together!

12. Customer Objection: *"Are you sure this is for real?"*

***** THIS REBUTTAL SHOULD ONLY BE USED AS A VERY LAST RESORT OPTION WHEN ALL ELSE HAS FAILED.**

Agent Rebuttal: I assure you this is very much for real. Have you heard of our 30 Day Free Look Period? We send out your policy right away. Within 10 business days you will have your actual policy in your hands. You then have 30 days to look over your policy and the opportunity to cancel it, if you are not completely satisfied. We are simply applying for coverage now. It is not permanent unless you decide to keep it.

13. Customer Concern: *"What is the difference between term and whole life insurance?"*

Agent Rebuttal: In my humble opinion, term life insurance is a "temporary solution to a permanent problem". Term means, it's going to terminate. Somewhere between age 70-80, a term policy will expire, run out. When you have to start all over again with life insurance at a higher age, guess what else is higher? - the premiums! Most seniors want a decent whole life insurance plan that never changes, because they are living on a certain budget every month. Let's get this settled now, so you will not be scrabbling around in your 70-80's, as we don't want to have this conversation again at that time.

14. Customer Concern: *"We live in a bad economy, should I take this coverage now?"*

Agent Rebuttal: I appreciate your honesty, (Customer Name). The economy hasn't been bad just today. Think of how hard it would be on your family if they suffered your loss in the future, and then had to come up with an additional \$5-7-12,000? The funeral home does not do business for free. Think how hard it would be if your premium payments kept going up, because you waited. Your plan here will never change at the coverage amount and premium you sign up for. Then, your family will always be protected at monthly premiums you can afford.

15. Customer Concern: *"Will I be able to get more coverage later?"*

Agent Rebuttal: Do you like apple pie? If I were to prepare, then give to you a hot, steaming, freshly baked apple pie, with a half gallon of vanilla ice cream to go with it, would you eat the whole pie all at once? (Pause for customer response – "No") Of course not. You can take a slice of pie that is comfortable now, and always come back later for another slice. Same principle here. You take a slice of coverage that is comfortable

for you now, and if your family ever wants you to get more later, you simply call my desk direct to get another slice of the “coverage pie” later. Funeral costs go up about 5% each year, so you may want to look at this again in another 3-5 years.

16. Read “How YOU Can MASTER Final Expense” to gain more effective objection/rebuttals.

Spike Questions

**To invoke curiosity throughout your sales presentation, ask additional questions that “spike” customer interest, scattered throughout your presentation delivery.*

***Your benefits should sound like an untold “mystery” to the customer. Intriguing. Captivating! Your final expense plan should initially come across as the “best kept secret” in the entire funeral protection industry. Interject words picture and questions that invoke curiosity:*

- **Are you aware that we have no-cost, extra benefits in your area that come to you directly by applying for one of our plans?**
- **Did you know that as a Licensed Field Underwriter, I can qualify folks who have been rejected and refused by almost everyone else?**
- **Remind me to share with you later how your entire funeral is paid for, after only one premium payment!**
- **Did you know that we have the technology at my department, so that NO PAPERWORK is required for you to fill out, if you qualify for one of our plans here?**
- **Don’t let me forget to share with you how your entire family, and some friends, may also receive benefits, without having to send a card in to my department.**

****These thought-provoking questions create intrigue in the customer’s mind, as never-before-heard-of benefits that an agent may explain in greater detail later, if a customer proceeds forward. Make qualifying for one of your plans a “mystery of anticipation”. This keeps the customer on the “edge of their seat” and eager to move forward with you!*

BURIAL EXPENSES

Social Security pays a death benefit of \$255 and only to the surviving spouse. The Veterans Administration death benefit for a surviving spouse of a veteran, if you qualify, is roughly \$450-\$800. (1)

Funeral Home Expenses (2)

<u>Service</u>	<u>Cost</u>
Professional Service Charge.....	\$500-1,200
Transfer of the Deceased.....	\$175-300
Casket.....	\$1,900-6,000
Use of Viewing Facility.....	\$350-900
Embalming.....	\$200-700
Cosmetology.....	\$100-300
Service Car/Van/Limo/Hearse.....	\$400-600
Memorial Service/Chapel.....	\$500-700
Flowers.....	\$250-500
Graveside.....	\$400-600
Cemetery Charges	
Plot/Vault.....	\$800-2,000
Headstone and Engraving.....	\$350-1,000
Opening/Closing of Grave.....	\$350-1,500
Special Ceremonies.....	\$200-500
Total.....	\$1,700-5,000
Grand Total.....	\$6,475-\$21,800

Other Expenses Often Forgotten

- Out of town guests: travel, hotel, meals.
- Lawyer's fees.
- Unpaid medical bills: hospital, doctor, nursing care.
- Unpaid debts: loans, credit cards, business accounts.

(1) www.socialsecurity.gov

(2) Various online sources used to estimate costs. Prices subject to change and may vary from state to state. www.funeral-help.com, www.motleyfool.com, www.funeralswithlove.com, U.S. Senate Committee on Aging 2001.

30 *Important Decisions Loved Ones Must Make Immediately For Funeral Arrangements.*

- 1. Contact Doctor / Coroner.**
- 2. Contact Funeral Director.**
- 3. Contact Clergy.**
- 4. Contact Cemetery or Memorial Park.**
- 5. Notify Relatives and Friends.**
- 6. Select Pallbearers.**
- 7. Notify Insurance Agents.**
- 8. Notify Newspaper and Write Obituary.**
- 9. Select organist / Music**
- 10. Select Cemetery Plot.**
- 11. Determine Order of Funeral Service.**
- 12. Pick a Casket.**
- 13. Choose Vault or other Container.**
- 14. Select Clothing.**
- 15. Decide on Flowers.**
- 16. Make Transportation Arrangements.**
- 17. Select Announcements/Thank you Cards.**
- 18. Determine Time and Location of Funeral.**
- 19. Determine Time and Location of Viewing.**
- 20. Provide Vital statistics about the Deceased.**
- 21. Get Death Certificate.**
- 22. Provide Contact Information of all people to be notified.**
- 23. Make Arrangements for out of town Guests.**
- 24. Respond to sympathetic Phone Calls.**
- 25. Answer Cards and Letters.**
- 26. Greet Callers, Friends, and Relatives.**
- 27. Prepare and Sign Necessary Papers.**
- 28. Pay for Funeral Expenses.**
- 29. Provide Food and Meals.**
- 30. Choose Headstone.**

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by

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